

ration to Britain c.1000 to c.2010 (J410/08)

British thematic study has been developed in conjunction with BASA.



Thematic study focuses on patterns of change and continuity in Migration to Britain over a long period of British history, c.1000–c.2010.

It includes a broad sweep of time in which British society, cultural, economic and political life has been shaped by continually changing patterns of migration.

Thematic study focuses on patterns of continuity and change over time although issues of cause, sequence and historical significance are also important elements of the study.

Over 1000 years, the thematic study is a different type of historical practice from the depth studies and even the period study. The broad sweep is covered by the unit precludes the listing of specific events in the manner of other parts of the specification.

Therefore, the study is divided into three eras and the eras are divided into broad sections. The eras and sections have been chosen as vehicles through which learners can investigate a number of key issues.

- Reasons for immigration – differing political, economic, social and religious reasons.
- The experience and actions of immigrants – positive actions and experiences such as community cohesion and contribution, and negative experiences and resistance to discrimination.
- Responses to immigration – including responses from government and established communities.
- Impact of immigration – including social, cultural, economic, religious and political impacts.
- The impact of immigration on Britain's relationship with the wider world.
- (from c.1500) Ideas of national 'identity' – how we have differently defined 'Englishness' and 'Britishness' over time.

Learners should consider the following concepts when studying this unit: society, culture, economy, politics, migration, empire, identity, racism and resistance.

Topics	Content Learners should have studied the following:
1000–1500 Issues: Reasons for immigration The experience and actions of immigrants Responses to immigration Impact of immigration The impact on immigration of England's relationship with the wider world	Population diversity in England before 1066; the impact of the Norman Conquest; resistance to the Normans in William's reign. Jews in England: their first arrival in 1066 and their treatment and experiences until their expulsion in 1290. Immigrants in England during the Middle Ages: the lives and impact of resident 'aliens'; their treatment by the authorities and the population generally; the extent to which they integrated.

c.1500–1900 Themes: • Reasons for immigration • The experiences and actions of immigrants • Responses to immigration • Impact of immigration • Ideas of national 'identity' • The impact on immigration of Britain's relationship with the wider world	Africans in sixteenth century England: reasons for their arrival; their experiences. The foundation of the East India Company and arrivals from the Indian subcontinent – <i>Lascar</i> and other Asian merchant seamen, child servants and <i>ayahs</i>, including how they arrived and their lives in England. The growth of African communities in Britain: reasons including the Royal African Company and the trade in enslaved Africans, loss of the American colonies and the expansion of the British Empire. The readmission of Jews in 1656 and their experiences; religious refugees – the arrival of Protestant refugees from the 1670s including the Huguenots and the Palatines: their reasons for emigrating, their reception, their impact, and the extent of their assimilation. Impact of the Industrial Revolution on migration: Irish and Scottish migrants to England; the impact of migrants on political movements including the Abolition movement and the Chartists; Eastern European Jewish immigrants, their experiences and impact. The process of naturalisation and denization: government legislation on immigration and nationality, including the Naturalisation Act of 1870.
1900–c.2010 Themes: • Reasons for immigration • The experiences and actions of immigrants • Responses to immigration • Impact of immigration • Ideas of national 'identity' • The impact on immigration of Britain's relationship with the wider world	The continued growth of diverse port communities in the early twentieth century. Government legislation in the first half of the twentieth century: the reasons for, and impact of, the Aliens Act 1905, the Status of Aliens Act 1914 and the British Nationality Act 1948. The arrival of Jewish refugees in the 1930s; different attitudes towards Jews in Britain in the 1930s; the experiences of migrants and their descendants during the two world wars; the experience of Poles who settled in Britain after the Second World War. Commonwealth migration after the Second World War: the varied reasons for this immigration; the impact of immigrants; the experiences of immigrants; the resulting debate over immigration – political racism and antiracism; the impact of race relations legislation and immigration controls including the 1962 Commonwealth Immigrants Act and the 1981 British Nationality Act. Immigration as a political issue c.1990–c.2010: the debate over a 'multi-cultural society'; attitudes towards, and treatment of, political refugees and asylum seekers; the issues raised by EU 'open borders'.